

wish to modify. Second, we need to know how to access the property that we wish to modify. Finally, we need to know how to modify it.

This may seem trivial in stating, as it seems fairly obvious. However, JavaScript can sometimes be slightly counterintuitive, as it has been used as a playground for experimentation by different browsers in a bid for market share. Also, we need to be able to trigger this change based on some event that occurs. For example, a user clicking on text.

First, one of the easiest ways to access any element on the page is using its 'id' attribute. 'id' is similar to variable names — they are used to refer to an element in particular, and are be reused or repeated. So while designing the HTML page, we need to ensure that any elements we wish to manipulate have unique ID's assigned to them, so that we may use them in the JavaScript code.

The 'document' object contains references to all the items that are part of the HTML page. Using the 'document' object you can access elements in the following ways:

- `document.getElementById('element_id')`
This method will return a reference to the element on the page which has an id of 'element_id'.
- `document.getElementsByName('element_name')`
This method will return an array of elements with the name 'element_name'
- `document.getElementsByTagName('tag_name')`
This method will return an array of all the tags named 'tag_name'

Now that you have a reference to the object or objects you wish to manipulate, the next step is to access these properties. Attributes of the element can be directly accessed by using the '.' operator. That is, to change the color of the background of the page, you would set the objects 'bgColor' property to whatever the new color is required to be. Styles associated with the element can be changed using the 'style' property of the object. In HTML, use lower case for all tags and attributes, while in JavaScript we use camelCase. Also, CSS supports using the hyphen to separate words in style names. However, JavaScript doesn't support this feature. In JavaScript, the hyphen denotes subtraction.